Colour for your website and business

Yes, mainly where you sell worth, celebration and long durability. Gold promises quality, but can easily feel ostentatious.

In business gold is a colour that **invites trust in exceptionality**, but at the same time carries the label of extravagance. It can feel luxurious, festive, traditional and modern. That is why it is good to know what you are promising before you let it into a logo, a website or an advert.

By itself, though, it **does not attract customers** like a magnet. It can help create **a striking impression**, but what still decides is mainly **what you sell**, **to whom** and **how well** it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Gold can say, for example

"It is valuable." "It is festive." "It is premium." "It is something special."

- **Luxury and celebration.** Gold is often used for jewellery, chocolate, watches and gifts.
- **Prestige.** Awards, medals, cards. Too much gold, though, can feel unattainable.
- **Tradition.** Gold can recall the long history of a brand.
- **Warmth.** A matt gold can feel friendly.
- **Ostentation.** Without a calm companion it can feel like a shop window.

Depending on the shade it also feels different. Champagne is **delicate and modern**, antique gold **traditional and earthy**, rich gold **striking and festive**.

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Simple tips

Keep to measure

A gold accent works better than a gold area. Less shine, more calm.

Show the product

A gold packaging on a gold background disappears. Give it contrast.

Shade by role

Rich gold for celebration, antique gold for tradition, champagne for modern.

Legibility

Gold text on a light background is hard to read. Watch size and contrast.

A human face

Luxury does not have to stand in the doorway with its arms folded. Add clear language.

Colour blindness

About 1 in 12 men has trouble telling red and green apart. Dark text on a light background is the safest choice for most people.

Professions where it is a Yes

The rule is simple. When you sell worth, celebration or exceptionality, gold can help you.

Jewellery, watches and gifts

Gold here belongs to the material as well as the colour. Watch that the shine does not say more than the product itself.

Confectionery and gastronomy

Gold foil and lettering convey a gift and celebration. For everyday food it can feel exaggerated.

Awards and programmes

A gold medal and a gold card show the highest level. What matters is what is really behind it.

Weddings, celebrations and art

Gold can support a festive impression. Wood and a gentle companion calm it.

Professions where it is a No

This is not a ban for whole fields. What decides is the interplay of colour, text, photographs and setting.

- **Caring for people.** Too much shine can feel unattainable.
- **Playful and light services.** For services promising lightness and playfulness gold can create different expectations.
- **Clinics and counselling.** Ostentation can clash with confidentiality.
- **Long texts on a website.** Gold text on a light background is tiring.
- **Product presentations.** A gold filter can distort the real colours.

Most important is not whether a design looks expensive. It is whether a person understands where they have come and what they can expect.

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Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer, and ask “What would you expect from such a place or service?” **Is the offer visible, or mainly the gold?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that gold means worth.

A question for you

“What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?”

Examples from the market

You know gold from pralines, cards and watches. Here are **a few examples** that show what it can do.

- **Ferrero Rocher (confectionery)**
  The pralines went on sale in 1979 in Italy and in Europe from 1982. Each is wrapped in golden foil. Michele Ferrero is considered the inventor.
- **American Express (financial services)**
  The gold card appeared in 1966. The company was founded in 1850. The gold colour meant the highest card available.
- **Lindt Gold Bunny (confectionery)**
  The gold bunny was created in 1952. It is wrapped in gold foil with a red ribbon. Aha. Gold makes chocolate into a gift.
- **Rolex Day-Date (watches)**
  Rolex introduced the model in 1956 at the Basel fair. The original watches were made only in 18-carat gold or platinum. In 1965 the first American president to wear the gold Day-Date was Lyndon B. Johnson and Rolex then promoted it as the watch of presidents.

What they have in common is that gold carries a simple message. **The highest level, a special moment.** And it mostly does not outshine what is around it.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, on customers and on how consistent the brand is. Take it as an idea to test, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

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